

FREE PARENT RESOURCE



The Executive-Function Parent Starter Kit

Four practical pages to reduce conflict, build useful routines, and help students take the next step.

Start here: A student can understand what to do and still need support with starting, planning, organizing, remembering, regulating emotions, or checking the work.

This week, focus on one skill

- Choose one recurring struggle. Do not try to fix the whole child or the whole school year at once.
- Ask the student what makes that moment hard.
- Make the next action small enough to begin in two minutes.
- Use one visible reminder instead of repeating the same lecture.
- Review what helped after seven days and adjust one part at a time.

A helpful change in language

Instead of	Try
You're being lazy.	What is making the first step hard right now?
I already told you three times.	Which reminder would help you notice the next step?

Remember: The goal is not perfect performance. The goal is a stronger skill, a protected relationship, and growing independence.

Look Beneath the Behavior

Before correcting the student, identify the executive-function barrier that may be blocking success.

What you notice	What may be happening
Starting	The task feels too large, unclear, boring, or emotionally loaded.
Planning	The student sees the finish line but not the smaller steps.
Working memory	Directions disappear while the student is trying to act on them.
Time awareness	Five minutes and thirty minutes may feel almost the same.
Organization	Materials and information do not have one dependable home.
Flexibility	A change, mistake, or unexpected demand makes it hard to shift.
Self-monitoring	The student may not notice what is missing until someone points it out.

Three questions before giving another reminder

- Does the student know exactly what finished looks like?
- Can the first action be seen and completed quickly?
- Would a written or visual cue work better than another spoken reminder?

Try saying: I'm not here to take over. Let's find the smallest step that helps you get moving.

CLEAR: One Calm Conversation

C

Correct: Correct the story before correcting the child. Replace blame with curiosity.

L

Learn: Learn the pattern: when, where, and under what conditions does the struggle appear?

E

Encourage: Notice effort, strategy, recovery, honest communication, and results.

A

Accountability: Make the commitment small, specific, visible, and owned by the student.

R

Remind: Use one respectful cue, then gradually fade it as the routine becomes reliable.

A complete CLEAR script

Parent: I can see this is getting frustrating. Missing the start does not mean you do not care. What part feels confusing or heavy? Let's choose one action you can finish in the next two minutes. I'll point to the checklist once, and then you take the shot.

When emotions are high

- Pause the problem-solving conversation.
- Lower the number of words and demands.
- Return to the plan after everyone is calmer.
- Contact an appropriate licensed professional or emergency service for urgent safety concerns.

One Week. One Skill. One Review.

Parent prompt	Write your plan
The one moment we will improve	_____
The executive-function skill involved	_____
The smallest first action	_____
The one reminder we will use	_____
What the student will own	_____
How we will notice progress	_____
Our seven-day review time	_____

Teacher collaboration email

Copy and personalize: Subject: One shared support for [Student Name]

Hello [Teacher Name],

We are working on [one executive-function skill] at home. We have noticed that [brief observable pattern]. The strategy we are trying is [one small cue or routine]. Is there one similar support that would be practical at school? We would appreciate a brief update after two weeks so we can adjust together.

Thank you for partnering with us.

KEEP BUILDING THE PLAYBOOK

Visit GUSExperience.org for parent resources, coaching information, and The Parent's Playbook for Executive Function.

Educational information only. This resource is not therapy, medical care, diagnosis, or academic subject tutoring.